Lesson 5

CONSECRATION

Aim: To give a challenge for deeper commitment to a holy living.
Introduction: God's desire is to use each one of us for His glory and honor.

We are compared to a "vessel" ready for the Master's use. But just as a vessel can be used only when it is clean and available, God can use us only when we are consecrated to Him and ready for His use.

2 Corinthians 8:5 "And they did not do as we expected, but they gave themselves first to the Lord and then to us in keeping with God's will."

Romans 12:1 "Therefore, I urge you, brothers, in view of God's mercy, to offer your bodies as living sacrifices, holy and pleasing to God-this is your spiritual act of worship. 2 Do not conform any longer to the pattern of this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what God's will is-his good, pleasing and perfect will."

I. What is Consecration?

It means to be " set apart" or separated for use by the Lord. It is giving of our whole being to God for service.

Gk. "Qadash" to concecrate, dedicate, devote, to observe as holy, keep sacred

II. **Why Consecrate ourselves?**

A. God has chosen us to become a holy people.

1 Peter 2:9

B. God is holy and so we must be holy also.

1 Peter 1:16

C. God will only use people who are consecrated to Him. *2 Timothy 2:20-21*

D. God has made us His temple.

1 Corinthians 3:16

III. **Practical ways of Consecrating ourselves.**

Romans 12:1,2

"Therefore, I urge you, brothers and sisters, in view of God's mercy, to offer your bodies as a living sacrifice, holy and pleasing to God—this is your true and proper worship. ***2*** *Do not conform to the pattern of this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what God's will is—his good, pleasing and perfect will."*

A. We must decide as an act of our will.

B. Present ourselves to be transformed by the renewing of our mind.

C. Forsake worldly influence.

Romans 6:13,16 "Do not offer the parts of your body to sin, as instruments of wickedness, but rather offer yourselves to God, as those who have been brought from death to life; and offer the parts of your body to him as instruments of righteousness. 16 Don't you know that when you offer yourselves to someone to obey him as slaves, you are slaves to the one whom you obey-whether you are slaves to sin, which leads to death, or to obedience, which leads to righteousness?"

Example of Consecration in the Old Testament.

Consecration for priesthood ministry, Leviticus 8

Through part of Aaron's body touched by the blood sacrifice, representing the consecration as a whole.

A. The ear - listening to the Word.

B. The thumb - doing the will of God.

C. The toe - walking in his path.

Application:

Let us yield ourselves to God so that He can use us for His honor!